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WAR DEPARTMENT
WASHINGTON

December 17, 1941.

MEMORANDUM FOR GENERAL WATSON:

Will you please show to the President the attached letter received today from Mr. T. V. Soong enclosing copy of telegram from Stalin to Chiang Kai-shek.

Henry L. Stimson

Secretary of War.

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"ABCD"

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CHINA DEFENSE SUPPLIES, INC.
1601 V Street, N. W.
Washington, D. C.

December 15, 1941

[redacted]

Dear Mr. Stimeon:

For your information I enclose copy of a telegram Stalin sent to Chiang-Kai-shek, dated Moscow, the 12th of December. A copy of the same has been given to the State Department.

Yours sincerely,

T. V. SOONG

Enclosure

The Secretary of War
Washington, D.C.

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UNCLASSIFIED

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SECRET

TELEGRAM TO GENERAL CHIANG KAI-SHEK FROM STALIN

(Translation from Chinese)

"Your telegram only reached me yesterday. I am deeply appreciative of your kind consideration. I am in perfect agreement with you that the long heroic struggle China has put up against Japan, and the present anti-Japanese front in the Pacific are part and parcel of the general anti-Axis front. At the same time the anti-German front assumes special significance in the anti-Axis front, because Germany is the strongest partner of the Axis.

"Soviet Russia today has the principal burden of the war against Germany. And Soviet Russian victory over Germany constitutes a great hope of the other members of the anti-Axis front, Great Britain, the United States and China. It is my opinion that under the circumstances the Soviet today ought not to divert its strength to the Far East, when it is beginning to attack the German armies, for by dispersing our strength the difficulties of the German armies will be lessened. I beg you therefore not to insist that Soviet Russia at once declare war against Japan.

"Soviet Russia must fight Japan, for Japan will surely unconditionally break the Neutrality Pact. We are preparing to meet that situation, but it takes time to prepare. Therefore I again implore you not to take the lead in demanding that Soviet Russia at once declare war against Japan.

Stalin"

Moscow, December 12, 1941